

May 25-26, 2026 - US strikes on Iranian missile launch sites and boats, Iran threatens to retaliate

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9:30 A.M. GMT+2, MAY 27, 2026



Key developments

• **Iran warns US:** The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps **threatened to retaliate** after the US carried out what it described as **“self-defense strikes”** on Iranian **missile launch sites and boats** around the Strait of Hormuz. The IRGC also claimed that 25 vessels, including oil tankers, transited Hormuz during the “last day and night.”

- **War negotiations:** The US and Iran are working toward a memorandum of understanding, but disputes over language concerning Iran's nuclear program and sanctions have held up a deal.
- **Web access:** Internet activity in Iran has been partially restored following a monthslong blackout, according to watchdog NetBlocks.
- **In Lebanon:** Israeli airstrikes killed 31 people in Lebanon on Tuesday, Lebanon's health ministry said, marking one of the deadliest days since the ceasefire in the country took effect in April. It comes as Israel began ground operations north of its self-declared military security zone in southern Lebanon, an Israeli military official said.

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“Every step forward in the negotiations brings a glimmer of hope,” says China's Foreign Minister



by Kathleen Magramo and Sylvie Zhuang



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Lebanon says Israeli strikes killed 31 in one of the deadliest days since ceasefire



by Mohammed Tawfeeq and Tamara Qiblawi

A neighbor walks through the rubble caused by an Israeli airstrike in Tyre, Lebanon, on Tuesday. *Adri Salido/Getty Images*

Lebanon's Health Ministry said Israeli airstrikes killed 31 people and wounded 40 others on Tuesday, in one of the deadliest days since the ceasefire in Lebanon took effect back in April.

In a statement, the ministry said the dead and wounded included

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Iran accuses US of violating ceasefire and attacking commercial shipping

by Mohammed Tawfeeq

Iran on Tuesday accused the United States of repeatedly violating a ceasefire and carrying out attacks on Iranian commercial vessels, according to a Foreign Ministry statement.

The ministry said the US had continued what it called “unlawful and unjust actions” since the announcement of a ceasefire and had committed “numerous maritime robberies” against Iranian commercial ships. It also accused Washington of flagrantly violating the ceasefire in Iran’s Hormozgan region over the past 28 hours. Strait of Hormuz is located along the southern coast of Iran’s Hormozgan region.

On Monday, the US military conducted “self-defense strikes” targeting Iranian missile launch sites and boats around the Strait of Hormuz amid a ceasefire between the two countries and ongoing negotiations to end

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Recap the latest on US-Iran talks and key developments in the Middle East



by Maureen Chowdhury

Trump says his Iran deal won't be like Obama's. Will it?

1:55

US President Donald Trump said he will host a **Cabinet meeting at the White House** on Wednesday.

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Trump moves Camp David Cabinet meeting due to weather

by [Kit Maher](#)

President Donald Trump said his Cabinet will no longer convene at Camp David on Wednesday, citing “possible bad weather.”

The Cabinet meeting will instead occur at the White House, as usual, he said.

“Based on the possible bad weather conditions tomorrow, we will be having our Cabinet Meeting in the White House, and will be postponing the Cabinet trip to Camp David,” Trump **posted on Truth Social**.

Trump has previously sounded a sour note on the presidential retreat in Maryland.

“Yeah, Camp David is very rustic, it’s nice, you’d like it. You know how long you’d like it? For about 30 minutes,” Trump said in an **interview** before taking office in 2017.

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9:20 P.M. GMT+2, MAY 26, 2026



Iran's Revolutionary Guard says 25 vessels transited Hormuz in past 24 hours

by Mohammed Tawfeeq

Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) claimed Tuesday that 25 vessels, including oil tankers, passed through the **Strait of Hormuz** over the past 24 hours after receiving permission and security coordination from its navy.

In a statement carried by Iran's semi-official Tasnim News, the IRGC Navy said the vessels, which included container ships, transited the strategic waterway during the "last day and night" with coordination and security provided by its forces.

CNN could not independently verify the shipping traffic numbers.

The IRGC Navy also said it was maintaining what it described as "intelligent control" over the Strait of Hormuz and warned that "any act

of aggression will be met with crushing blows.”

The Strait of Hormuz is one of the world’s most important shipping chokepoints, with a significant share of global oil and gas supplies passing through the narrow waterway.

8:46 P.M. GMT+2, MAY 26, 2026



Iranians greet partial internet restoration with skepticism after 88-day blackout



by Aida Karimi and Mohammed Tawfeeq

Iranians reacted with a mix of skepticism, caution and sarcasm on Tuesday after internet monitors reported a partial restoration of online access following months of near-total isolation under a nationwide shutdown imposed by Iranian authorities.

“Yes, I’m connected, but I still have to use a VPN. Don’t get too excited though — the internet isn’t fully open, it’s just no longer completely shut down,” a 46-year-old man in Tehran told CNN on the condition of anonymity because of security concerns.

A VPN (virtual private network) essentially creates a private, digital tunnel that shields your online activity from hackers, advertisers and trackers.

Others voiced frustration online, casting the limited return of access as

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Israel repeatedly strikes Bekaa Valley, hitting road near Lebanon's largest dam



by Charbel Mallo, Dana Karni, Oliver Sherwood and Sana Noor Haq

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7:05 P.M. GMT+2, MAY 26, 2026



Leaders of Iran and Qatar discuss de-escalation in phone call

By Catherine Nicholls and Eyad Kourdi

The leaders of Iran and Qatar spoke over the phone today about de-escalation efforts regarding the ongoing conflict in the Middle East, according to a readout of the conversation shared by Qatar's Amiri Diwan, the administrative offices of the emir.

Qatar's emir, Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani, spoke to Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian, where they "reviewed the latest developments in the region and the efforts being made to reduce

escalation, preserve regional security, and strengthen peace and stability,” the Amiri Diwan said.

Al Thani reiterated his country’s “firm position calling for prioritizing political and diplomatic solutions,” it continued, as well as “the need for all parties to exercise the highest levels of responsibility and wisdom to spare the region the repercussions of escalation.”

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